Short-Form Storytelling (Writing Guide)

If you want to work with Kallaway 1:1 to scale your content on social media (limited spots available): LINK

Optimal Scriptwriting Structure

1. **Hook** (1-2 sentences)
2. **Lock-In Zone** (2-4 sentences)
3. **Body Block 1** (at least one contrarian take/interesting insight) (3-5 sentences)
4. **Rehook 1** (1 sentence)
5. **Body Block 2** (at least one contrarian take/interesting insight) (3-5 sentences)
6. **Rehook 2** (1 sentence)
7. **(Optional) Body Block 3** (at least one contrarian take/interesting insight) (3-5 sentences)
8. **(Optional) Closing** (1-2 sentences)
9. **CTA** (1 sentence)

Scriptwriting Components

When it comes to scriptwriting, you have the following core components:

- **Hook** - *the first 1-2 lines of the script designed to clarify subject and build initial curiosity*
- **Lock-In Zone** - *the next 2-4 lines designed to ratchet curiosity and build trust in the incoming claim/story/framework*
- **Body Blocks** - *containers for making an interesting point and then supporting with facts, examples, or rationale*
- **Rehooks/Transitions Sentences** - *single sentences designed to open a new curiosity loop or transition between body blocks*
- **Closing/Wrap-up** - *an optional summary or clear takeaway to crystallize the payoff*
- **CTAs** - *a call out for the viewer to take another action if they want more info/value*

Core Scriptwriting Principles:

- Reduce fluff as much as possible
- Keep scripts as short as possible *(ideal length is 45-90 seconds, but don't add length unless necessary)*

- Maintain a clear and obvious logic flow *(each sentence should either connect the previous or be clearly starting a new chain of thought. Jumping too much from one thing to next within the story makes it impossible to follow)*
- Tease the value as early as possible (make it known why someone should keep paying attention)
- Use as simple words as possible
- Maintain high clarity and comprehension over everything *(use words where the meaning is already embedded)*

Detailed Approach For Each Component

Hook

- Goal -> ensure the viewer is opted into wanting to hear more about this topic
- Four S's of Hookswriting
    - **Subject** - Make sure the subject of the video is clearly stated in the first sentence.
    - **Stakes** - Make sure there's a reason your target viewer feels compelled to keep watching
    - **Simple** - Make sure the words you use are extremely simple and easy to understand
    - **Superclear** - Make sure the structure of the sentence is extremely punchy, clear, and easy to follow.
- If you want my complete guide to hooks, here's a 1.5 hour long video that comes with 37 pages of notes (you can feed to AI): https://luma.com/sfa-hooks

Lock-In Zone

- Once the viewer is on-target, the lock-in zone's job is to convince them that the rest of the video will be worth it. Few talk about this, but it's very important
- Typically, lock-in happens from one of the following
    - **Teasing proof** *(yours or others that resulted from the incoming substance)*
    - **Teasing a favorable transformation/emotional response** *(that resulted from the incoming substance)*
    - **Clarifying contrast** *(immediately framing why this will be different than the common belief)*
    - **Introducing magic box** *(framing the unknown name of some term, method, or framework that they'd want to know)*
    - **Objection handling** *(proactively addressing and dismissing their core objections on this topic)*
    - **Double down** *(intensify the claim made in the hook)*
- This is the most fluid and flexible of all components. Once you understand this happens, you can't unsee it. Best way to execute is to model off of examples

- The exit psychology after this section needs to be, “Damn, I have to keep listening.” Most easily achieved by driving one of the core emotions tied with unlocking a desired result

Body Blocks

- Body Blocks are the core substance of the video
- Typically, each body block tees up a nonobvious or interesting frame and then includes 2-4 sentences supporting/defending why that frame is true
- Most videos aim to have at least two of these, so they can drive a double dopamine release. If you get a viewer two hits of nonobvious value in a video, they will follow at a much higher rate

Rehooks

- Rehooks are single sentences designed to reset the attention hourglass for a viewer
- The average viewer has about 20-25 seconds of attention span on any video, even if they actually want to watch it. Because of this, you need to hack into their brain and reset the hourglass once in the middle to earn another 25 seconds
- The way to do this is by creating contrast and additional curiosity between blocks 1 and blocks 2. For example, “Now that was interesting, but honestly, it is nowhere near as wild as this…”
- These can seem a bit corny and forced if you don’t know what you’re doing, so try your best to figure out how to make the transition clean

Closing

- Not all videos require Closing, but if you’re not running a CTA, this is a helpful 1-2 sentences wrap-up that both summarizes the takeaway and helps remind the viewer why they watched in the first place
- If you’re running CTAs on every video like I am, you don’t need closings

CTAs

- Ideally these are value ramps (ramps to additional on-target value) that are maximally aligned to the video topic. Lead magnets are most effective version of CTA
- Use a CTA in every single video so you can measure conversion

---

If you want to learn how to actually apply all of these in-depth in the scriptwriting process (limited spots available): LINK